

TRB-004 — Discovery

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Request: *Process flow needs to be more systematically driven*

Proposed Solution: TRB-004 — System-driven process flow

What is proposed

- Replace the current self-service navigation model (user clicks around to figure out the next step) with a guided wizard that owns the order of operations from the user's first action to a completed rebate submission.
- Maintain a server-side state machine for each in-progress submission with explicit states (e.g., `account\_setup → business\_verified → invoices\_uploaded → review → submitted → confirmation`). The state determines what the user sees next.
- Every state has an obvious primary CTA ("Upload your first invoice", "Review and submit") and a single secondary action ("save for later" or "back"). Hide unrelated nav until the current step is done.
- On login, route the user to the state they left off in. If they're on the dashboard with nothing in flight, route them to "Start a new submission" as the primary CTA.
- Add lightweight progress indicators (e.g., a top-of-page stepper "Step 2 of 5: Upload invoices") so users always know where they are and what's left.
- Preserve an "advanced / power user" escape hatch — a top-level menu that lets a returning user jump to any state they have access to — but it's not the default path.

Desired outcome

- A first-time user can complete a submission without reading documentation or asking support which button to click next.
- A returning user with an in-progress submission lands directly on the next thing they need to do, not a dashboard.
- Customer success deflects "I don't know what to do next" tickets, which are currently a meaningful chunk of inbound.
- The product's own analytics surface which state has the highest drop-off, so the team can target the next round of UX investment.

Success criteria

- New-user funnel: median time from signup to first completed submission drops by $\geq 30\%$ versus the pre-change baseline.
- Support volume: tickets tagged "navigation / what do I click" drop by $\geq 50\%$ in the first 60 days post-launch.
- Returning-user routing: after deploy, $\geq 90\%$ of returning users with an in-progress submission land on the correct next step within 1 click of login (measured by event analytics).
- E2E test: a brand-new test user can complete a full submission flow with no manual hint, navigating only

by primary CTAs.

- Internal dashboard shows per-state completion rate and median time-in-state for the last 30 days, refreshable on demand.